VAYU | YOUR PERSONAL CROP GUIDE

# Avocado

How to grow it on your land

Prepared for: General guide (no location chosen)
Prepared on 2026-11-09

Good money in the right place (mild, frost-free hills of the south and west, and the north-east hills) but slow to pay back, needs two compatible flowering types, and fails in hot dry or frost-prone areas.

| DIFFICULTY | MONEY NEEDED | RISK | FIRST RETURN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **4 of 5** | **High** | **High** | **grafted plants bear earlier than seedlings** |

How to read this guide: [S1] marks a line backed by a source listed on the last page. (general knowledge) marks a line that has not been verified against a source. Lines starting **For your land** use the numbers for your location.

## In this guide


- Your priorities: what to do first, in order
- Your planting plan: how much to buy and prepare for your plot
- How to grow it: planting, water, nutrition, pests and diseases, monitoring, harvest, risks
- If your conditions are different, and the sources behind every line

# Your land at a glance

# Your priorities

Ordered by what matters most on your land.

**1. Talk to your KVK first**
Take this guide to your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra and ask for their local advice and trusted planting material. (general knowledge)

**2. Start small**
Plant or build a small trial first. Learn the crop on your own land, then expand from what actually worked. (general knowledge)

**3. Line up a buyer before you scale**
Know who will buy, in what form and grade, and how it will reach them. (general knowledge)

# Your planting plan for 1 acre

| What | How much | Basis |
|---|---|---|
| Trees at 6 m x 6 m | **about 112** | your plot size x cited amounts [S1] |
| Planting pit 1 m x 1 m x 1 m, filled with farmyard manure and topsoil (1:1) | **112 pits** | your plot size x cited amounts [S1] |

Sums of the cited per-plant and per-hectare amounts for your plot size. Real needs vary with soil and variety; confirm with your KVK.

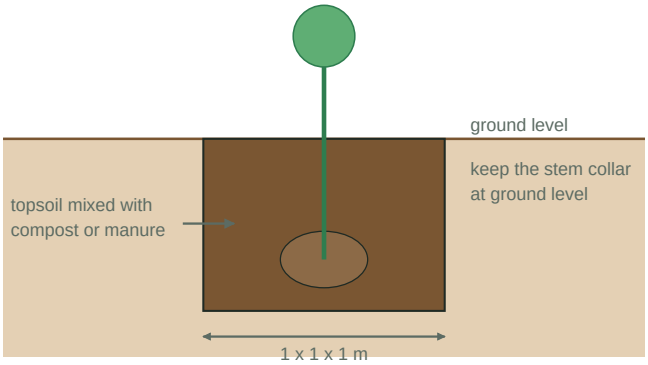
# Planting material

- Use grafted plants of a variety suited to your zone. ICAR-IIHR (Chettalli) released Arka Supreme (A type) and Arka Coorg Ravi (B type) for Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu. [S1]
- Plant both A-type and B-type varieties whose flowering overlaps (1:1 or 2:1) for pollination. [S7]
- Buy from an ICAR-IIHR / KVK / state-approved nursery; avoid unverified grafts. (general knowledge)

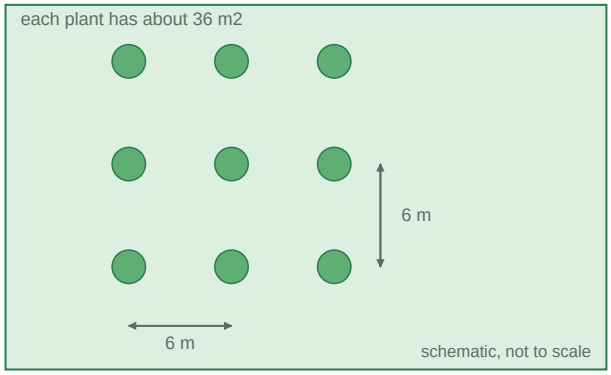
# Land preparation and planting

- Dig 1 m x 1 m x 1 m pits in April-May and fill with farmyard manure and topsoil (1:1). Plant in June-July or September depending on rainfall. [S1]
- Grafts at about 6 m x 6 m (about 110 plants per acre); seedlings need wider spacing (8-10 m). [S1]

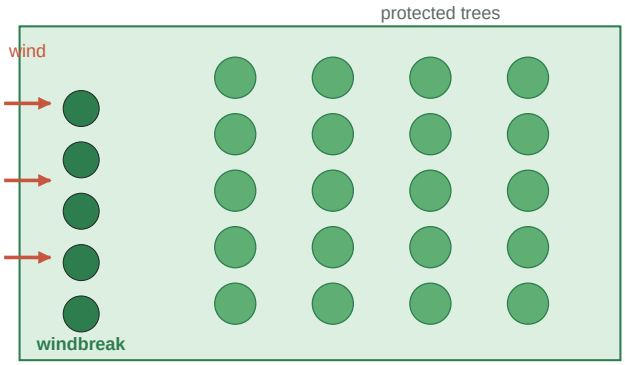
- It cannot tolerate shade or strong winds (brittle wood); give it full sun and a windbreak. [S6, S3]




Planting pit




Plant spacing, top view

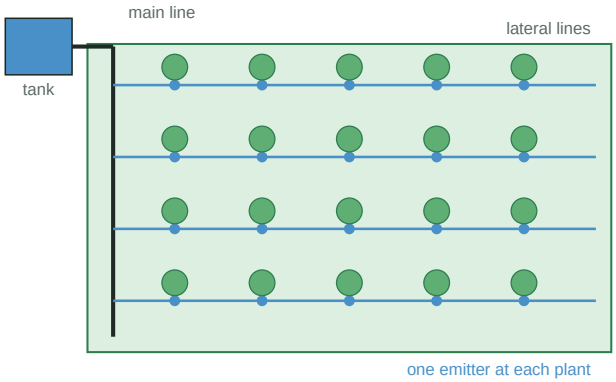



Windbreak on the windward side

# Irrigation

- Avoid waterlogging; use basin or drip irrigation and irrigate during flowering, fruit set and fruit growth. [S5, S7]

- Mulch the basin to conserve moisture. (general knowledge)




Drip irrigation layout (schematic)

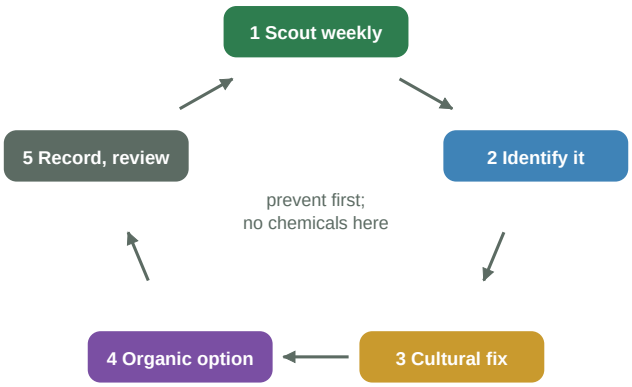
## Nutrition (organic)

- Compost and farmyard manure each year, increasing the amount as the tree grows; avoid heavy pruning, which pushes leaf growth over fruit. [S1, S6]

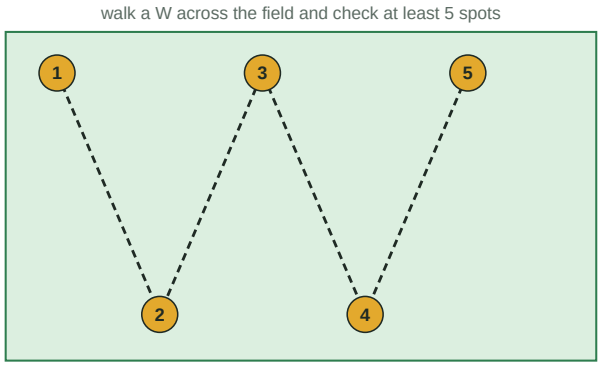
## Pests and diseases (organic and cultural only)

- Thrips: a thick (about 15 cm) mulch layer reduces pupae in the soil. [S6]
- Fruit flies: collect and destroy fallen infested fruit; use pheromone traps. [S6]
- Main diseases are anthracnose and scab; improve air flow, avoid wet canopies and remove infected fruit and twigs. [S6]

- For anything beyond these organic and cultural steps, ask the nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university for their current recommendation. (general knowledge)




Pest and disease loop: prevent first, then look, fix, review




How to walk the field when scouting

## Monitoring

- Inspect new shoots, flowers and fruit every week or two for thrips, fruit-fly stings and dark spots. (general knowledge)
- Record flowering dates (September-November or February-March) and fruit set to learn your block. [S1]

## Harvest, yield and post-harvest

- Fruit is harvested when mature but still hard and ripens off the tree; harvest by clipping with the stalk. (general knowledge)
- Yield depends heavily on variety, pollination and age; do not rely on blog yield figures, ask ICAR-IIHR Chettalli or your KVK for local numbers. (general knowledge)

## Risks and costs

- Payback is slow (several years) and the tree is the main capital item. (general knowledge)
- In India it is concentrated in the southern and western hills; check proven local growers before planting at scale. [S8]

## If your conditions are different

What to do if your land, or the season, turns out different from the numbers above.

- **Cold weather** (fixable): It withstands a mild winter but cannot tolerate freezing; fruit is very sensitive to freezing temperature. Do not plant where hard frost occurs; in mildly cool sites choose a sheltered slope. [S4, S5]
- **Heat** (fixable): It cannot tolerate very high temperatures or hot dry winds. In hot dry plains this is a poor bet even with irrigation; windbreaks and shade only partly help. [S6, S4]
- **Low rainfall** (fixable): Rainfall near 1,000-1,500 mm suits it. In lower rainfall give regular irrigation, especially at flowering, fruit set and fruit growth when it is sensitive to moisture stress. [S1, S5]
- **Too much rain** (fixable): It cannot tolerate waterlogging. Plant on mounds or slopes with good drainage; avoid black (clay) soil. [S1, S7]
- **Soil pH** (fixable): Aim for pH about 5-7 (5.5-6.5 ideal). It does not tolerate saline soil. [S1, S7]

### About chemicals

This guide gives organic and cultural methods only. It does not name or dose pesticides, fungicides or chemical fertilisers; for those, follow your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university and the label of any registered product.

## Sources

**[S1]** https://epubs.icar.org.in/index.php/IndHort/article/download/154271/59781/460093
**[S3]** https://www.scribd.com/document/505084289/Avocado
**[S4]** https://pt.slideshare.net/BimalLodaya/package-of-practices-of-avocado
**[S5]** https://www.scribd.com/document/505084289/Avocado
**[S6]** https://www.slideshare.net/slideshow/avocado-pptx-avocado-persia-americana-miller-is-an-evergreen-tree-of-the-family-lauraceae-seedlings-grow-upto-a-height-of-60-feet-cultivated-trees-are-topped-and-maintained-around-30-feet-height/281212929
**[S7]** https://www.fao.org/3/X6902E/x6902e06.htm
**[S8]** https://epubs.icar.org.in/index.php/IndHort/article/download/146186/54395/410696

Advisory aid from published sources and general agronomic knowledge, not a guarantee of yield or income and not a substitute for local extension advice. Lines marked 'general knowledge' are not verified against a source.